Extraction Optimization Study

Recipe and invoice extraction: hold 98% accuracy first, then cut time and cost. A follow-up to the Milestone 3 audit, measured live on 27 documents

Prepared for	Clayton Linville (Product Owner) and the development team (Viktor Musiienko, PM). Section 9 is the hand-off for the developers.
Date	October 13, 2026 (runs on October 12)
Builds on	Milestone 3 Audit Report, section 5 (document processing). This study replaces the model and prompt recommendation in §5.6–5.9 with a faster, cheaper set-up that is at least as accurate.
The bar	At least **98% line accuracy** across all documents, with the 95% interval also at or above 98%, and **zero errors left unflagged**. Only configurations that clear the bar compete on time and cost.
What was run	27 documents (17 used while tuning, 10 held out), each read 3 times per configuration. 21 configurations across Gemini 3.8 Flash, Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite, Claude Haiku 5.5 and Claude Sonnet 5.5, plus routing and escalation variants. 846 extraction jobs, 1,058 model calls.
Spend	$6.65 of API usage for this study ($27.83 for all live testing since the audit). The temporary keys were never written to any repository and are deleted from the test machine.

1. Summary

Recommendation: pipeline A. Typed documents (Word, workbooks, PDFs with a text layer) go to Gemini 3.8 Flash in *line-reference* mode: the app numbers every printed line and the model answers with line numbers instead of copying text, using short output keys. Long documents are first split at recipe starts. Photos go to Gemini 3.8 Flash at medium resolution, and Claude Haiku 5.5 reads each photo in parallel as a second opinion. Two new code checks run on every line. On all 27 documents this measured **99.6% line accuracy** (95% interval 99.4%–100.0%), **no unflagged errors**, a median of **5.0 s** per document, **27 s** at the 95th percentile, and **$0.0073 per document**.

	Accuracy	Unflagged errors	Median / 95th pct time	Cost per document	Lines staff must check
M3 as delivered	85.1%	114	1.6 s / 13 s	$0.0036	0% (errors are silent)
Audit brief (evidence-first + 3.8 Flash)	99.5%	0	6.7 s / 58 s	$0.0101	10.6%*
A. Recommended	**99.6%**	**0**	**5.0 s / 27 s**	**$0.0073**	**1.5%**

* With the audit brief's code checks; measured on pipeline A's outputs.

- **A beats the audit brief's set-up on every measure:** 28% cheaper per document, the 95th-percentile wait falls from 58 s to 27 s, and accuracy holds (99.6% vs 99.5%).
- **Staff checking falls about 7×.** With the audit brief's checks, about 1 extracted line in 10 is flagged for a person to look at, most of them correct. Two code checks and the second read on photos bring that to 1.5% of lines (about 1 in 66). Every wrong line was still flagged.
- **API cost is not the constraint.** Pipeline A costs about $52 a month for 100 locations today, and about $100 after Gemini 3.8 Flash doubles its price on January 1, 2027. Staff time spent checking lines is the cost that matters, which is why the review load gets its own section (§6).
- **Two alternatives also clear the bar.** B puts typed documents on Claude Haiku 5.5: 99.6% accuracy at $0.0033 per document (less than half of A), but slower (95th percentile 55 s). It is the switch to make if volume grows after the 2027 price rise. C puts typed documents on Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite: the fastest (median 2.3 s) at 99.0%, with a

thinner margin over the bar.

- **Not worth it:** Claude Sonnet 5.5 (it skips event sheets as "not a recipe", 84.5% overall, about 3× the cost); Haiku without thinking (96.9%, below the bar); prompt caching (our fixed prompt is short); Gemini's half-price Flex tier (median wait 131 s against 7 s, worst 16 minutes); escalation cascades (errors are already flagged).
- **Gemini 4 is not on our API key yet** (checked October 12). The harness can test it in one command the day it appears. It should replace 3.8 Flash only if it clears the same bar and is cheaper or faster (§8).

Main caveat. The 10 held-out documents keep our formats and change the content (names, amounts, units), and the held-out invoices were generated. So the study shows that results hold on new content in layouts we know. It does not show they hold on layouts we have never seen. Before rollout, run the same harness on 30–50 new real documents (§10).

2. The bar and how it is measured

Line accuracy = lines extracted exactly right ÷ (lines the document contains + wrong, invented or merged lines produced). A missed line and a wrong line both count against it, so a model cannot score well by returning less. "Exactly right" means ingredient name, amount and unit for recipes, and description, quantity, unit price and line total for invoices.

- **Answer keys.** Hand-made for the short recipes, handwritten cards and invoices. For the four long documents (two cookbook chapters, two event sheets) the key is built from the printed lines by a script and was then corrected by hand. The generated invoices carry their own key, written from the same data that drew them.
- **Unflagged error** = a wrong line that the code checks did not mark amber. The bar allows none. A flagged error costs a cook a few seconds on the review screen. An unflagged error goes silently into food cost.
- **Development and held-out sets.** Prompts and checks were tuned on 17 documents. 10 more were held out: six recipe documents that keep our formats with new content (a second event sheet, a second cookbook chapter, four single recipes including a .docx), and four generated invoices (a clean template with fees, a distributor layout with catch-weight lines, a credit memo, and a photographed produce invoice).
- **Runs and intervals.** Every configuration read every document 3 times; results pool the runs. The 95% interval is a bootstrap over documents (whole documents are resampled, because errors cluster in a few of them), so it reflects how much the result depends on which documents are in the set.
- **Time** is wall-clock per document, including file preparation, from one machine with several configurations running at once. Treat it as relative, not as a production guarantee. **Cost** is computed from the token counts each API returned, at list prices on October 12, 2026, including cached-token and Flex discounts where they applied.

Disclosure: changes made after seeing results. Two code checks (§6) were designed after the second round of runs, and one invoice rule ("row has no amounts") after the first held-out pass. All three are generic rules, not fixes for one document, and none changes accuracy (they only change which lines are flagged). They still need confirming on documents nobody has looked at (§10).

3. Results

Configurations that clear the bar (accuracy and the low end of its interval both at least 98%) are blue or green. Every configuration except M3 flags every error it makes; the differences are in how many lines they get right, how long they take and what they cost. The full table, with development and held-out sets shown separately, is Appendix A.

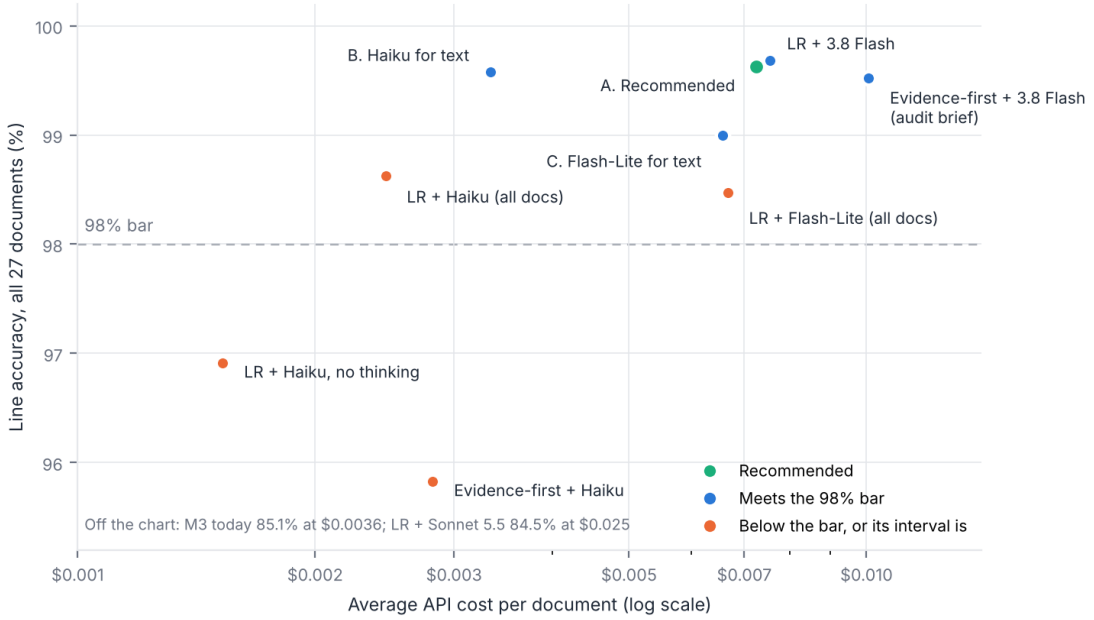


Figure 1. Line accuracy against average API cost per document, all 27 documents, 3 runs each. A, B and C include the Haiku second read on photos.

Configuration	Accuracy (95% interval)	Held-out	Unflagged	Median	95th pct	Cost/doc	Verdict
A. 3.8 Flash, line-reference, compact + split; photos 3.8 medium	99.6% 99.4%–100.0%	99.4%	0	5.0 s	27 s	$0.0073	Recommended
B. Haiku 5.5 for typed text; photos 3.8 medium	99.6% 98.8%–100.0%	99.1%	0	8.1 s	55 s	$0.0033	Cost option
C. Flash-Lite for typed text; photos 3.8 medium	99.0% 98.3%–99.7%	98.6%	0	2.3 s	21 s	$0.0066	Speed option
Line-reference + 3.8 Flash, all documents	99.7% 99.4%–100.0%	99.6%	0	6.3 s	46 s	$0.0075	Meets bar
Evidence-first + 3.8 Flash (audit brief)	99.5% 98.9%–100.0%	99.2%	0	6.7 s	58 s	$0.0101	Superseded
Line-reference + Haiku 5.5, all documents	98.6% 95.9%–99.8%	99.1%	0	7.7 s	55 s	$0.0025	Fails: interval reaches 95.9% (handwriting)
Line-reference + Flash-Lite, all documents	98.5% 96.0%–99.6%	98.7%	0	2.4 s	21 s	$0.0067	Fails: interval reaches 96.0% (handwriting)
Line-reference + Haiku 5.5, no thinking	96.9% 94.2%–98.3%	96.9%	0	3.8 s	32 s	$0.0015	Below bar
Evidence-first + Haiku 5.5	95.8% 90.9%–99.2%	95.0%	0	7.9 s	64 s	$0.0028	Below bar
Line-reference + Sonnet 5.5	84.5% 60.5%–99.7%	88.5%	0	4.9 s	61 s	$0.0246	Below bar (skips event sheets)
M3 as delivered	85.1% 66.5%–92.5%	85.1%	114	1.6 s	13 s	$0.0036	Below bar; errors silent

Table 1. All 27 documents, 81 jobs per row; "Held-out" = the 10 held-out documents only; code checks v2 throughout. A, B, C include the Haiku photo read (slower read's time, both reads' cost).

4. What moved the needle

Each lever was measured on its own against the same base (line-reference + 3.8 Flash, all documents) so its effect can be read directly. Percentages are relative changes.

Lever	What changes	Accuracy	Time	Cost	Verdict
Line-reference instead of copied evidence	Model returns line numbers; code fills in the printed line	99.5% → 99.7%	95th pct 58 → 46 s	-25%	Adopt
Compact output keys	One-letter JSON keys, expanded in code; output tokens −19%	99.7% → 99.6%	median 6.3 → 5.3 s	-12%	Adopt
Split long text at recipe starts	A small first call lists where recipes begin; pieces run in parallel	99.7% → 99.7%	95th pct 46 → 30 s	+8%	Adopt
Compact + split together		99.5%	5.0 s / 28 s	-6%	Adopt
Photos at medium resolution	Gemini media resolution MEDIUM instead of HIGH; photo input tokens −42%	99.7% → 99.8%	no change (re-checked unloaded)	−13% on photos	Adopt
Code checks v2	Line accounting + unit-inside-name (§6)	no change	no change	none	Adopt: review 10.6% → 7.3%
Second read of photos by Haiku 5.5	Photo lines turn green only when two vendors agree	no change	none (runs in parallel)	+$0.0017 per photo	Adopt: review 7.3% → 1.5%
Thinking level	3.8 Flash has no "minimal"; Flash-Lite low vs minimal: 98.4% vs 98.5%	–	–	–	Not a lever
Haiku 5.5 with thinking off		98.6% → 96.9%	median 7.7 → 3.8 s	-38%	Reject: below bar
Prompt caching	Claude: 80% cache hits in a busy queue. Gemini: fixed prompt too short to cache	none	none	−6 to −11% on Claude	Enable on Claude only
Gemini Flex tier	Same model, best-effort queue at half price (16 matched jobs)	same model	median 131 s vs 7 s; worst 952 s	−50%	Bulk back-catalog only
Batch APIs (Gemini, Claude)	Results within 24 hours	same model	up to 24 h	−50%	Bulk back-catalog only
Escalation cascade	Cheap model first; 3.8 Flash re-reads when anything is flagged (Haiku → 3.8: 18 of 66 documents escalated)	99.7%	95th pct 57 s	$0.0050	Not needed: errors are already flagged

Table 2. Lever effects on all 27 documents. Base for rows 1–5: line-reference + 3.8 Flash (99.7%, 6.3 s median, 46 s 95th pct, $0.0075 per document). Flex compared on the same documents and runs.

Why line-reference wins

In the audit brief's evidence-first prompt, the model copies each printed line as proof and code checks the copy against the document. That proof is what makes errors visible, but copying costs output tokens, and output tokens are most of both the cost and the time. In line-reference mode the app numbers the lines it already extracted ("[12] 2 cups sugar") and the model answers with `lines: [12]`. Code fills in the printed line, so the proof is exact by construction: the model can no longer paraphrase its evidence. Photos and scanned PDFs have no text to number, so they keep the evidence-first prompt.

Why split at recipe starts, not at a fixed size

Splitting a long document into fixed-size pieces made the 47-second chapter about 3× faster, but it cut recipes in half: 21 of 139 lines landed in the wrong recipe. Pipeline A first asks Flash-Lite (minimal thinking, under a second, about $0.002) for the line where each recipe begins, then splits only there. Across every split run (18 document-runs across three configurations) **no line moved to a different recipe** compared with the unsplit read. The slowest held-out chapter dropped from about 50 s to about 11–16 s.

5. Where the time goes

Almost all of the wait is the model writing its answer. Gemini 3.8 Flash wrote about 127 output tokens per second in these runs, and Flash-Lite about 414. A single recipe needs 400–900 output tokens; a cookbook chapter or a dense event sheet needs 4,500–8,000, which is 30–50 seconds on 3.8 Flash in one call. So the levers that work are fewer output tokens (line-reference, compact keys) and parallel pieces (split at recipe starts). Thinking settings made no difference here.

Document type	A (3.8 Flash)	B (Haiku text)	C (Flash-Lite text)
Short recipe (Word/PDF text)	4.1 s	7.6 s	1.9 s
Long multi-recipe document	23.2 s	53.2 s	7.5 s
Workbook (recipe sheets)	11.3 s	18.8 s	6.4 s
Handwritten recipe photo	about 25 s (Gemini 12–15 s; Haiku 20–25 s)	same as A	same as A
Invoice PDF (text layer)	4.6 s	6.2 s	1.8 s
Invoice photo	about 5–6 s (both reads)	same as A	same as A

Table 3. Median seconds per document. Photo times: the Gemini read from a separate re-check run one document at a time; the Haiku second read from the main runs. A photo is ready when the slower read finishes, so Haiku sets the pace on handwritten cards. One handwritten card once took 96 s in a single call: rare tail delays happen, so queue time-outs should be at least 120 s, with one retry.

Pipeline A's slowest documents are dense event sheets (about 22–35 s). Each one is a single "recipe" of 40 short dishes, below the split threshold. Lowering the split threshold for documents with many short sections is the next time lever. It is not yet measured.

6. Cutting the lines staff must check

A flagged line costs a person a few seconds; a flagged line that was right all along is pure waste. With the audit brief's checks, about 1 line in 10 was flagged, mostly lines that were correct. Almost all of those came from two places, and both are fixable in code:

- **Shared lines on event sheets.** "Vanilla Morel Demi: ½ lb Dried Morels, 2 Bottles Champagne, … Veal Demi, Rosemary, Mirepoix" holds several ingredients, some without an amount. The old check flagged "Rosemary" because its line shows amounts, even though those amounts belong to its neighbours. **Line accounting**: flag an entry with no amount only when its printed line shows more amounts than the entries sharing that line have claimed.
- **Photos.** A photo has no text layer, so nothing can be checked against the page, and every photo line was flagged. **Second read**: Claude Haiku 5.5 reads the same photo in parallel. A line turns green only when both vendors give the same name, amount and unit (and price, on invoices). Two different vendors rarely misread the same handwriting the same way. In these runs, no line both models agreed on was wrong.
- **Unit inside the name** (new check). Rarely, a model puts the unit into the name ("slices smoked salmon", no unit; "ears of Corn"). That costs a recipe wrongly, and the old checks let it through. It happened in one of the Flex-tier runs. The check flags a line whose unit is empty and whose name starts with a unit word.

Pipeline	Audit-brief checks	+ line accounting, unit-in-name	+ second read on photos	Wrong lines left green
A. Recommended	10.6%	7.3%	**1.5%**	0
B. Haiku for text	10.6%	7.2%	**1.1%**	0
C. Flash-Lite for text	10.6%	7.8%	**1.8%**	0

Table 4. Share of all extracted lines shown amber on the review screen (all 27 documents, 3 runs). For comparison, M3 as delivered flags nothing and leaves 114 wrong lines green.

7. What it costs

Cost per document depends mostly on how much the model has to write, so it is shown by document type. Monthly figures use assumed volumes; change them to your own. "2027" applies Gemini 3.8 Flash's announced January 1, 2027 price ($1.50 / $7.50 per million input / output tokens, double today's).

Document type	A	B	C	Audit brief
Short recipe (Word/PDF text)	$0.0026 2027: $0.0053	$0.0011 2027: $0.0011	$0.0023 2027: $0.0023	$0.0041 2027: $0.0081
Long multi-recipe document	$0.0255 2027: $0.0504	$0.0085 2027: $0.0085	$0.0230 2027: $0.0230	$0.0373 2027: $0.0745
Workbook (recipe sheets)	$0.0189 2027: $0.0378	$0.0068 2027: $0.0068	$0.0167 2027: $0.0167	$0.0317 2027: $0.0634
Handwritten recipe photo	$0.0080 2027: $0.0138	$0.0080 2027: $0.0138	$0.0080 2027: $0.0138	$0.0070 2027: $0.0140
Invoice PDF (text layer)	$0.0028 2027: $0.0057	$0.0010 2027: $0.0010	$0.0025 2027: $0.0025	$0.0041 2027: $0.0082
Invoice photo	$0.0041 2027: $0.0072	$0.0041 2027: $0.0072	$0.0041 2027: $0.0072	$0.0033 2027: $0.0066

Table 5. Average API cost per document. A, B and C include the Haiku second read on photos.

Scenario (documents)	A	B	C	Audit brief	M3 today
Onboard one restaurant (one-off) 120 short recipe, 10 long multi-recipe document, 3 workbook, 25 handwritten recipe photo	$0.83 2027: $1.60	$0.44 2027: $0.59	$0.76 2027: $0.90	$1.13 2027: $2.26	$0.37 2027: $0.37
One location, a normal month 10 short recipe, 1 long multi-recipe document, 3 handwritten recipe photo, 90 invoice pdf, 30 invoice photo	$0.45 2027: $0.87	$0.26 2027: $0.37	$0.42 2027: $0.53	$0.57 2027: $1.13	$0.18 2027: $0.18
100 locations, a normal month (+8 onboardings) 1960 short recipe, 180 long multi-recipe document, 24 workbook, 500 handwritten recipe photo, 9000 invoice pdf, 3000 invoice photo	$51.97 2027: $99.81	$29.11 2027: $41.33	$48.06 2027: $60.28	$65.53 2027: $131.06	$21.05 2027: $21.05

Table 6. API cost per scenario. M3 is cheapest only because it does not check its own work.

Reading the numbers. Even at 100 locations the whole difference between the options is tens of dollars a month. One cook-hour checking flagged lines costs more than a month of extraction for a single location. That is why the recommendation favours accuracy and a low review load over the cheapest model. Revisit B after January 1 if volume is in the thousands of locations, or if Gemini 4 changes the picture.

8. Models, and getting ready for Gemini 4

Model	Price per 1M tokens (in / out)	What we measured	Role
Gemini 3.8 Flash	$0.75 / $3.75 (from Jan 1, 2027: $1.50 / $7.50)	Most accurate on everything, best on handwriting. Writes about 127 tokens/s.	Default for all routes
Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite	$0.30 / $2.50	Fastest (about 414 tokens/s). 99.0% on typed text (C), but weaker on handwriting (lasagna card 50 of 57 lines) and a distributor invoice.	Speed option for typed text; outline call
Claude Haiku 5.5	$0.10 / $0.50	Cheapest. 99.6% on typed text (B), but slow with thinking on, and below the bar with it off. Misreads handwriting (pavlova card 27 of 33).	Second reader on photos; cost option for text
Claude Sonnet 5.5	$2 / $10	Strong on single recipes, but labels event sheets "other" or "menu" and returns little or nothing from them (84.5% overall). About 3× A's cost.	Not recommended
Claude Opus 5.5	$4 / $20	Not tested: twice Sonnet's price, and Sonnet showed no accuracy gain to buy.	Not recommended
Gemini 4	Not published	Announced Sep 30 with limited access. No Gemini 4 model is listed for our API key (checked Oct 12). Rumoured pricing (about $2 / $10) is unverified.	Test on release (below)

Table 7. List prices on October 12, 2026.

Pin model versions. M3 calls `gemini-flash-lite-latest`, an alias that Google repoints without notice, so extraction quality can change overnight. Use explicit model IDs and change them only after the harness passes.

Testing Gemini 4 the day it appears

From `backend/`, with the API key in the environment and `<id>` the model ID Google publishes:

```
python3 ../audit/extraction-benchmark/gold.py      # writes the case lists (once per checkout)
EF_SHEETS=1 EF_IMAGES=auto EF_MEDIA=MEDIUM LR_COMPACT=1 LR_OUTLINE=1 LR_CHUNK=4000 \
  npx tsx ../audit/extraction-benchmark/runner.ts "lr-gemini:<id>" \
  ../audit/extraction-benchmark/cases_all.json ../audit/extraction-benchmark/out/study/lr-g4 3 3
# then add  "Gemini 4": ["study/lr-g4"]  to CONFIGS in study.py,
# set its price in PRICE in score.py, and run:
cd ../audit/extraction-benchmark && CHECKS_V2=1 python3 study.py
```

Decision rule. Adopt Gemini 4 for a document type only if, on both the development and held-out sets: (1) accuracy is at least 98% and its 95% interval stays at or above 98%; (2) no error is left unflagged; (3) handwriting is no worse than 3.8 Flash's; and (4) at equal or better accuracy it is cheaper or faster than pipeline A, priced against 3.8 Flash's 2027 price. The same rule applies to any future model. About 81 jobs cost a few dollars and take under an hour.

9. The recommended pipeline, for the developers

Step	What happens	Model / setting
1. Prepare	Read the file in code. Word, workbooks and PDFs with a usable text layer become numbered lines ("[n] text", blank lines skipped). Images, PDFs that carry photos, and PDFs with under 80 characters of text go to the photo route.	No model
2a. Typed text	One line-reference call with compact keys. If the text is over about 5,200 characters: an outline call first, then split at recipe starts into about 4,000-character pieces, read in parallel. Line numbers stay global, so the pieces simply concatenate.	Gemini 3.8 Flash, thinking low; outline on 3.5 Flash-Lite, thinking minimal
2b. Photos	Evidence-first call at medium resolution, plus the same prompt to a second vendor in parallel. Lines both agree on (name, amount, unit, and price on invoices) are green.	Gemini 3.8 Flash, mediaResolution MEDIUM; Claude Haiku 5.5 with cached system prompt
3. Check	Code checks on every line, including line accounting and unit-inside-name; missed-line check on typed text (a printed line that starts with an amount but is covered by no entry).	No model
4. Review	Amber lines first, with the printed line beside each. Invoices: computed prices and totals that do not add up are amber.	No model

Implementation notes

- **Where.** `backend/src/modules/documents/extraction.ts`: add a line-reference extractor beside `GeminiExtractor`. `prepareInput` and `textChunks` already produce the text. Numbering, resolving line numbers back to printed lines, compact-key expansion and the outline split come to about 120 lines; the harness's `runner.ts` (`numbered`, `resolveLines`, `expandCompact`, `outlineStarts`, `splitAtStarts`) is a working reference.
- **Prompts.** The line-reference prompt is the evidence-first v3 prompt (audit report, Appendix B) with rule 2 replaced. The replacement rule, the compact-key note and the outline prompt are in Appendix B here. The schema swaps `evidence` for `lines: integer[]`.
- **Number words.** Parse "one", "two", "half", "a dozen" as amounts. Recipes written as prose ("Season one pound of Raw Tuna…") otherwise produce unparsed amounts.
- **Usage logging.** Store each call's token counts, cached tokens and service tier on the document job. That is what made this study's cost figures exact, and it is how a price change or a runaway document shows up in production.
- **Caching.** Put Claude's system prompt in a `cache_control` block (5-minute cache, 80% hit rate in a busy queue). On Gemini there is nothing to do: the fixed prompt is below the size where caching pays.
- **Time-outs.** Allow 120 s per call with one retry; one photo call took 96 s in an otherwise 15-second series.
- **Show the photo read early.** Haiku's second read is slower than Gemini's on handwriting. The review screen can show Gemini's lines as soon as they arrive, all amber, and turn agreed lines green when Haiku finishes.
- **Regression gate.** Run the harness (Appendix C) before any prompt, model or check change ships. The bar is the one in this report.

Code checks v2 (sketch)

```
// 1) Line accounting: an entry with no amount on a shared printed line is only suspect when the
//    line shows more amounts than the entries sharing it have claimed.
const shown = (printedLine.match(AMOUNT_WITH_UNIT) ?? []).length
const claimed = entries.filter((e) => sameLines(e, entry) && e.quantityText).length
if (!entry.quantityText && !entry.amountNote && shown > claimed)
  amber('evidence shows an amount the line lacks')

// 2) Unit inside the name: "slices smoked salmon" with no unit, "ears of Corn".
const first = entry.nameText.trim().split(/\s+/)[0].toLowerCase().replace(/[(,.]/g, '')
if (!entry.unitText && UNIT_WORDS.has(first)) amber('unit inside name')
// UNIT_WORDS: slice(s) bunch(es) ear(s) cup(s) clove(s) pinch head(s) stick(s) bag(s)
//   sheet(s) can(s) oz ounce(s) lb(s) pound(s) sprig(s) dash piece(s) scoop(s) bottle(s)
//   tbsp tsp quart(s) pint(s) gallon(s) g kg ml liter(s) pack(s) packet(s) box(es) case(s)
//   jar(s) container(s) clamshell(s) flat(s)

// 3) Photos: green only if a second vendor's read has the same name (similarity >= 0.5), amount and unit
//    (count units interchangeable), and on invoices the same price.
```

10. Risks and what to do next

- **Small, familiar test set.** 27 documents; the held-out ones keep our layouts. **Next:** collect 30–50 documents nobody has looked at (new restaurants' recipe files, three or four distributors' invoices, phone photos taken in a kitchen), key them, and run the harness. Keep that set as the permanent regression gate.
- **Checks tuned after seeing results.** Line accounting and unit-inside-name are generic, but were written after round 2. The new documents above are their real test.
- **Models change under us.** Providers update models and aliases. Pin IDs, log usage, and re-run the harness monthly and on every model change.
- **Price changes.** Gemini 3.8 Flash doubles on January 1, 2027. Pipeline A's monthly cost doubles with it; it stays small, but re-check B (Haiku for typed text) and Gemini 4 then.
- **Stricter models and the wrong-document rule.** Sonnet 5.5 refused event sheets under the rule that tells the model to stop on non-recipe documents. If the team moves to a stronger Claude model, that rule's wording needs re-testing on event sheets first.
- **Measured time is relative.** Latency came from one machine with many runs at once. Production times will differ; the ranking between options should not.

Appendix A. Full results

Configuration	All	95% interval	Dev	Held-out	Wrong lines	Not flagged	Clean docs	Median s	95th s	Cost/doc
M3 today (gemini mode, default alias)	85.1%	66.5%–92.5%	85.0%	85.1%	114	114	40%	1.6	13	$0.0036
Evidence-first + Gemini 3.8 Flash (brief's recommendation)	99.5%	98.9%–100.0%	99.7%	99.2%	2	0	98%	6.7	58	$0.0101
Evidence-first + Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite	93.6%	85.8%–98.1%	95.9%	90.2%	41	0	77%	2.7	23	$0.0068
Evidence-first + Claude Haiku 5.5	95.8%	90.9%–99.2%	96.4%	95.0%	5	0	81%	7.9	64	$0.0028
Line-reference + Gemini 3.8 Flash	99.7%	99.4%–100.0%	99.7%	99.6%	1	0	99%	6.3	46	$0.0075
Line-reference + Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite (low)	98.4%	96.0%–99.4%	98.0%	98.8%	12	0	93%	2.5	22	$0.0063
Line-reference + Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite (minimal)	98.5%	96.0%–99.6%	98.3%	98.7%	12	0	94%	2.4	21	$0.0067
Line-reference + Claude Haiku 5.5	98.6%	95.9%–99.8%	98.3%	99.1%	9	0	86%	7.7	55	$0.0025
Line-reference + Claude Haiku 5.5 (no thinking, cached prompt)	96.9%	94.2%–98.3%	96.9%	96.9%	22	0	79%	3.8	32	$0.0015
Line-reference + Claude Sonnet 5.5 (cached prompt)	84.5%	60.5%–99.7%	81.6%	88.5%	6	0	86%	4.9	61	$0.0246
LR + 3.8 Flash, compact output keys	99.6%	99.1%–99.9%	99.5%	99.7%	2	0	98%	5.3	41	$0.0066
LR + 3.8 Flash, long text split at recipe starts	99.7%	99.4%–100.0%	99.6%	99.7%	1	0	99%	6.3	30	$0.0081
LR + 3.8 Flash, compact + split	99.5%	99.2%–99.9%	99.6%	99.4%	3	0	96%	5.0	28	$0.0071
LR + 3.8 Flash, photos at medium resolution	99.8%	99.6%–100.0%	99.9%	99.6%	0	0	100%	6.7	46	$0.0074
Route: text → Flash-Lite LR (minimal); photos → 3.8 Flash	99.1%	98.1%–99.6%	99.4%	98.7%	6	0	96%	2.5	22	$0.0069
Route: text → Flash-Lite LR compact + split; photos → 3.8 Flash	98.9%	98.2%–99.6%	99.1%	98.6%	2	0	96%	2.3	15	$0.0064
Route: text → Haiku LR; photos → 3.8 Flash	99.5%	98.5%–99.9%	99.7%	99.1%	1	0	93%	7.7	55	$0.0032
Route: text → Haiku LR (no thinking); photos → 3.8 Flash	97.5%	95.6%–98.6%	97.9%	96.9%	16	0	84%	4.0	32	$0.0022
A. 3.8 Flash LR compact + split; photos 3.8 medium	99.6%	99.4%–100.0%	99.8%	99.4%	2	0	98%	5.0	27	$0.0069
B. Haiku LR text; photos 3.8 medium	99.6%	98.8%–100.0%	99.9%	99.1%	0	0	94%	8.1	55	$0.0030
C. Flash-Lite LR compact + split text; photos 3.8 medium	99.0%	98.3%–99.7%	99.3%	98.6%	1	0	98%	2.3	18	$0.0063

Accuracy columns are line accuracy. "Clean docs" = share of document-runs with no wrong line and at least 90% of lines found. Rows starting "Route" or A/B/C combine measured runs by document type (typed text from one run set, photos from another); each part ran in full. Code checks v2 throughout.

Appendix B. Prompt changes

B.1 Rule 2 of the evidence-first v3 recipe prompt, replaced for line-reference mode. The rest of the prompt is unchanged; the closing phrase "and the whole printed line as the evidence of each" becomes "and the same line number". The invoice prompt's evidence field becomes "lines: the number(s) of the printed line(s) the row comes from (never copy the row)".

```
2. LINE NUMBERS. The document arrives with a number in square brackets before each printed line
   ("[12] 2 cups sugar"). For every entry give in "lines" the number of the printed line it comes
   from; if its name and its amount are printed on different lines (a table read column by
   column), give both numbers. Never copy the line itself.
```

B.2 Compact output keys (appended to the system prompt; code maps keys back).

```
OUTPUT KEYS. To keep the answer short, the JSON uses one-letter keys: k = documentKind, r = recipes;
in a recipe t = titleText, y = yieldText, p = portionsText, c = components, i = its ingredient entries;
in a component n = nameText, y = yieldText, w = usedAsText; in an ingredient entry l = lines, s = section,
n = nameText, q = quantityText, u = unitText, a = amountNote, g = legibility ("c" clear, "u" unclear).
```

B.3 Outline prompt (Flash-Lite, minimal thinking, schema `{starts: integer[]}`).

```
The document arrives with a number in square brackets before each printed line. Give the number
of the line where each recipe begins: the dish's title line (or its first line when it has no title). A step,
part or component inside a recipe ("Step 2", "For the sauce") is not a new recipe. Give the numbers in order.
```

Appendix C. The harness

Everything in this report can be re-run from `audit/extraction-benchmark/` in the clone repository: the documents, answer keys, the runner (all modes and settings above), the scorer, and the study, cascade, cost-model and review scripts. Raw model outputs are archived in `results/`. API keys are read from the environment and are never stored.

runner.ts	Runs one configuration over a case list. Arms: m3-gemini, m3-claude, ef-gemini, ef-claude, lr-gemini, lr-claude. Settings via environment: EF_MEDIA, LR_COMPACT, LR_OUTLINE, LR_CHUNK, LR_THINK, GEMINI_TIER, CL_CACHE, CL_THINK.
score.py	Scores runs against the keys; code checks (CHECKS_V2=1 for v2); cost from recorded usage.
study.py / cascade.py	Tables 1, 2 and Appendix A; escalation simulations.
costmodel.py / review.py	Tables 5–6 (cost by type and scenario) and Table 4 (review load).
group.py	Checks that splitting never moves a line to a different recipe.
gold.py, autoref.py	Answer keys (development and held-out sets).